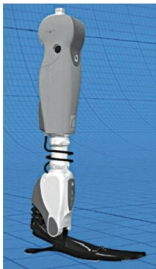


Arx Pax would require installation of the hover engines and an earthquake-proof base. Computers would automatically turn on the engines as soon as these sense an earthquake. These will also have ShakingAlert software system that senses earthquakes, integrated in the system, which has successfully detected earthquakes in the past.

Bionic legs that are thought-controlled

Researchers in Iceland have developed bionic legs that can be controlled by a person's thoughts alone. It involves surgically implanting myoelectric sensors (IMES) into a person's residual muscle tissue to measure and interpret signals travelling between the brain and its nerve-endings. The implanted sensors send wireless signals to the artificial limb's built-in computer, enabling subconscious, real-time control and faster, more natural responses and movements.

This new mind-controlled technology developed by Ossur for lower-limb prosthetics is designed to be compatible with its line of bionic feet, knees and legs. A coiled-wire receiver inside the prosthesis' cup picks up impulses and transmits these wirelessly to the robotic limb.



Bionic leg that can be controlled by thoughts (Image courtesy: Ossur)

A computer made out of water droplets

An assistant professor of bioengineering at Stanford University, the USA, Prof. Manu Prakash has created a water based computer. He, along with his two students, has devised a system with the help of tiny water droplets that could work as a computer clock.

For this, water droplets are trapped in a magnetic field. When applied to a flipped magnetic field, these form a precise motion in a fixed direction.

According to the team, the system can be made smaller by controlling millions of droplets with the help of the magnetic field, so that it can perform a higher number of operations on a single chip.

According to Prakash, this computer finds its application in biology and chemistry by converting the computer into a high-throughput laboratory.

Power gadgets from six metres away

A team of engineers from University of Washington, Seattle, the USA, has presented a research paper titled 'Powering the Next Billion Devices with Wi-Fi' that

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